

US–Iran Conflict Briefing

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Tanker strike off the UAE coast

- The Panama-flagged crude supertanker GEM NO.2 was struck by an unknown projectile 13 nautical miles west of Al Jazeera, UAE, on October 9; a fire broke out and was later extinguished. — [Reuters](#)
- The GEM NO.2 was fully laden with oil and at anchor off the UAE coast when struck; no group has claimed responsibility. — [Reuters](#)

Houthi-Saudi air exchange escalates

- Thursday's Houthi attacks on Riyadh's airports killed three Saudi nationals and injured several; a Saudia Airlines aircraft was damaged on the ground. — [Reuters](#)
- The Saudi-led coalition says it intercepted two Houthi ballistic missiles on October 8; falling debris hit a kindergarten and medical-clinic complex in Riyadh. — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- The Houthi spokesman claimed one ballistic missile plus two cruise missiles struck Riyadh airport on October 8; the exact composition is a Houthi claim and is contested. — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- Saudi airstrikes hit Houthi targets in Sanaa overnight on October 8-9, and the Saudi-led coalition says it destroyed three Houthi missile launch platforms; the platform figure is a coalition claim. — [Reuters](#)
- Houthi leader Abdul Malik al-Houthi warned in an October 9 televised speech that the strikes on Saudi Arabia "have not stopped." — [Wall Street Journal](#)

IEA accelerates oil stock releases

- The IEA agreed on October 7 to accelerate planned stock releases and prioritize diesel; France announced a ten-million-barrel diesel release the same day. — [Reuters](#)
- Italy has fully met its March IEA commitment of ten million barrels and is open to providing more once other European countries meet their pledges. — [Reuters](#)
- Germany will release up to fifteen million barrels of diesel, heating oil and crude under the G7 emergency plan. — [Reuters](#)
- Crude whipsawed on October 9: prices dipped intraday on Trump's no-attack remarks, then rebounded on renewed tanker-attack reports; official settles were Brent at \$104.72 per barrel, up zero point four percent, and WTI at \$91.85 per barrel, up zero point four percent. — [Wall Street Journal](#)

Diplomacy: Mecca pact advances, no movement on talks

- Pakistan's military spokesman confirmed to CNN on October 7 that Pakistani forces are already stationed in Saudi Arabia, without specifying numbers or capabilities; the confirmation came days after Pakistan, Saudi Arabia and Turkey agreed to rapidly deploy forces under the Mecca Joint Defence Agreement. — [CNN](#)

- A Reuters investigation published October 8 found Iran's security apparatus, judiciary and state broadcaster running a coordinated wartime campaign of fast-track executions, closed-door trials, coerced televised confessions and mass prosecutions to head off another uprising after the January 2026 protests, extending to threats against dissidents' relatives abroad. — [Reuters](#)
- No movement on the diplomacy track: Iran's reply to the US response on the Hormuz-reopening proposal is still pending, and the mediators continue to exchange messages. — [Reuters](#)
- President Trump said October 8 that the US is having "productive discussions" with Iran, will not attack Iran before the November 3 midterm elections, and will keep the naval blockade "in full force and effect." — [Reuters](#)

Markets

- Brent crude settled at one hundred four dollars and seventy-two cents per barrel on October 9. — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- WTI crude settled at ninety-one dollars and eighty-five cents per barrel on October 9. — [Wall Street Journal](#)
- The US ten-year Treasury yield closed at five point two four percent on October 9. — [Reuters](#)

Shipping

- Seven commodity vessels transited the Strait of Hormuz on October 6, per Kpler data; LSEG counted eight vessels on an all-vessels basis, and transits edged up to ten on October 7. — [Reuters](#)
- Crude crossing the Strait of Hormuz fell twenty-seven percent from a wartime high to at least ten point one million barrels per day, per Kpler data via Reuters. — [Reuters](#)

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